

Gonzalo Barrera Borla

Curriculum Vitae

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Experience

- Sep 2025 – **Data Scientist & ML Engineer (first data hire)**, *Sitch*, via Borlandux LLC
At Sitch — a matchmaking startup replacing swiping with curated candidate lists — we used LLMs liberally, including a matchmaking chatbot I helped build, then cut them back to where they paid: I replaced LLM-only affinity scoring with chat-NLP extraction, GBT match-probability models and greedy b-matching, cutting costs from >10K USD/mo in OpenAI fees to a few bare-metal VMs, holding human-curated match quality, while scaling from 3K to 30K MAU; I remain its sole maintainer on an hourly consulting basis.
- Aug 2024 – **Data Scientist, Anti-Fraud Team**, *Muun Wallet*, via Borlandux LLC
Aug 2025 Muun, a self-custodial BTC & Lightning wallet with an exchange-grade UX, micro-lends to users throughout their journey; our team managed the resulting counterparty risk across a global, high-risk userbase while keeping false positives near zero. Real-time incongruity detection plus ad-hoc, on-chain and Lightning contracts drove ≈ 2 BTC/mo of micro-fraud to near zero – over 200K USD/mo then.
- Jun 2023 – **Head of Data Science**, *Move 37*, via Borlandux LLC
Jan 2024 Led quantitative R&D (team of 4) for a pari-mutuel horse-racing syndicate across LATAM and the USA. I upgraded bet sizing from single-wager fractional Kelly to joint Kelly over correlated wagers, replaced independent-marginal sampling with estimated joint probability distributions for exotic bets. We scaled volume over $2\times$ at stable margins — several US tracks turned EV-positive after takeout — while adding trifectas and superfectas, and expanding to Brazil and Uruguay.
- Jan 2023 – **Owner & Principal Consultant**, *Borlandux LLC*, remote
My single-member ML/statistics consultancy: full-time embedded roles (above) plus shorter engagements. Selected projects: an order fulfillment-time prediction service integrated with the ERP of a US cold-storage warehousing provider (CSW); and a vendor-decoupling roadmap for Unilever USA's freight invoice payment operation (about USD 1B/yr over 500K+ invoices).
- Jan 2021 – **Engineering Manager, Data Science**, *Jampp*, remote
Sep 2022 I led the re-architecture of the prediction stack from our bespoke online-SGD logreg (one global model, expert-only tuning) to batch LightGBM: minutes-long trainings on millions of samples with no logloss regression, unlocking per-(client, geo) models. I wrote the team's career ladder and grew it to 12 people.
- Feb 2019 – **Senior Data Scientist**, *Jampp*, Buenos Aires
Sep 2020 Our team built the conversion-rate prediction system (win rate, CTR, CVR) behind Jampp's RTB bidder: online-SGD GLMs trained on billions of observations, scoring 1M+ auctions per second. The income-optimization engine I co-developed ("[Optimal Bidding: a dual approach](#)", AdKDD 2019; presented at [PyData BA 2019](#)) replaced 100+ per-client bidding problems with a single global objective on Jampp's bottom line. Annualized revenue grew $\approx 4\times$, from $\approx$ USD 15M to 60M+ over my tenure.
- Aug 2016 – **Expert Data Analysis Advisor**, *Jefatura de Gabinete de Ministros*, Buenos Aires
Jan 2019 I built the data model and ETLs of a BI system integrating National Public Administration systems: payroll for $\approx 400K$ civil and military employees, the $\approx$ USD 156B national budget with monthly execution status, and the administration's flagship-project board. I co-wrote [pydatajson](#), a CKAN-metadata library part of the IADB's "[Code for Development](#)" FOSS program.

Teaching

- 2023 – 25 **Teaching Assistant, 1st Class**, *Instituto del Cálculo, UBA*, "Intro to Statistics and Data Science" and "Data Laboratory"; materials at [fcen-amateur](#)
- 2021 H2 **External Professor**, *FCEyN*, "Machine Learning in Graphs" — [lectures](#), [materials](#)
- 2012 – 17 **Mathematical Olympiad Coach** — former international olympiad awardee

Education, Languages & Stack

- 2017 – 21 **MSc in Mathematical Statistics**, *Instituto del Cálculo, UBA*, GPA 10.0; [thesis](#) presented, defense pending (est. Sep 2026)
- 2009 – 14 **Licenciatura ($\approx$ MSc) in Economics**, *Facultad de Cs. Económicas, UBA*, GPA 8.94, *magna cum laude*, class valedictorian. [Thesis](#) (grade 10.0) available online.
- Languages Spanish (native), English (C2), French & Portuguese (advanced)
- Stack Fluent in Python (scientific stack), R, SQL and Unix shell; built and ran full systems on AWS, Azure and GCP with Terraform and Docker. Also: Stata, Tableau, Pentaho, Ruby/Rails, Django, PostgreSQL/MySQL, MATLAB, Java.